

INTELLECT AND WILL AS TOOLS OR HINDRANCES OF SELF-REALIZATION

Greetings, my dearest friends. God bless each of you. Blessed is this hour.

Again and again we have discussed that to understand yourself means finding your real self. Often we also discussed what this real self is. We did so from various aspects. You may have noticed in the past that I often change substantives to describe a term. I explained why I did so several times in the past. But it bears repeating because I see the danger you run into. I see that you have forgotten this explanation. When you use the same word over and over -- be it "image," "real self," or whatever else -- the meaning behind the word gets lost. It becomes dead. The moment it becomes a label, you repeat the word without really understanding what you are talking about. This also is why you attach such particular importance to a word. You argue about the meaning of some words, while you blindly speak words that once had a meaning for you when you truly experienced the significance, but in blind repetition, the living experience has gone out of it. You thereby lose the meaning. For, meaning is alive, it is forever fresh and is forever a spontaneous experience. This is why you have to guard yourself against it. You have to be aware of this temptation. That is why it is sometimes advisable to use another word because it makes you try to experience the meaning behind the word. If it cannot be done, keep on trying at all times. If, however, you cannot succeed, be aware that your innermost self does not, at the moment, recapture the inner meaning and the living experience. This awareness counts so much.

This phenomenon is a good example of the difference between the real self and the superficial layers of your personality. When you experience the living spirit of a term, it is your real self that does so. While the repetition of a word is done by your intellect, memory is the will to recapture that which was once experienced. When this happens, the meaning becomes lifeless. The experience has become a repetitive pattern. Your real self no longer functions.

Let us try to get a clearer understanding of how the real self comes into being and what obstructs it. It goes without saying that the obstruction is caused by the various layers and levels of personality that are in confusion and error, and by your lack of awareness that this is so. So, as you very well know, there is only one way, and that is knowing yourself. When you know there is a confusion, even before you know the solution, you are more aware of yourself and are therefore nearer to your real self.

You, in your world, are so conditioned to an overemphasis of the thought process, intellect, mind, or whatever you wish to call it -- as well as of will power whereby you believe that somehow you can really become yourself by a direct act of will and by directly using your thought process in order to grow and develop spiritually. For example, you have learned that to be good and to love indicates spiritual development. So you try to be good and loving by dictating your thoughts, by

directing your will power so to be. From all our previous work together, by now you know that this is not so. It amounts to wanting to be something that you are not.

Your real self cannot be governed by will or by force. It is a direct manifestation, not of thought and will, but a spontaneous, creative experience that comes into being unbidden, when least expected. This is very important to know, never to keep out of sight, always to realize. Unknowingly, unconsciously, undeliberately, and yet deliberately, you still hope and strive to have your real self manifest by acts of thought, of will, by indoctrinating yourself with concepts -- in other words, by intellectual processes. This cannot be done, my friends.

Now the question may arise, why then use your intellect, thought, will, as well as your arduous work on this path, at all? The answer is that by using your mind and your will in order to understand the confusion and error of your mind and misdirected will and motivations, you indirectly bring about the birth of the real self. It is an indirect result.

Here is a brief, overall explanation of the stages of spiritual development in connection with the subject under discussion. The most primitive stage of development is a state of being, without awareness. I mentioned this before in another context. Animal life, plant life, mineral life are in a state of being without awareness, without self-consciousness. Primitive man was only little removed from this state. He had a brain, of course, but he was functioning mostly on instinct. Only slowly was the brain function, or intellect, developed. From mineral life to primitive man, a slow ascendancy in awareness, intellect, and will can be noticed. The more this particular development proceeded, the less did the state of being exist, the more did it change into a state of becoming.

The next stage is a state of becoming, in awareness. Man is striving, using his intellect and will in order to survive in the material world. He needs these faculties in order to cope with the world of matter. Thought and outer will are of matter and are to be used to overcome matter. But they cannot be used in order to get into a state of being, which is not of matter. They can only be used in order to remove the surplus action through which error and confusion were created. They can be used to deal with that which is of the same kind. If thought and will overproduced and thereby created obstruction to the state of being, thought and will must be used in order to deal with its own production and never with the state of being -- the real you. Expressed differently, it means understanding yourself rather than hoping to bring out the real self by a direct act of will and thought.

The highest stage is the state of being, in awareness. This does not happen suddenly after you shed your physical body, but it can be experienced occasionally and increasingly while you are still in the body. This depends on how you use the faculties which have bred confusion and suffering, and out of using them for what by nature they were not destined.

Mankind now finds itself in the middle stage. It is the state of becoming, in awareness. But within this category, there are many different stages and degrees. Let us make an arbitrary division, for the sake of understanding. In the first half of this cycle, it is important to cultivate and develop intellect, memory, discrimination, will power. Without it, as I said, matter could not be mastered. To cope with life, man needs to learn, he needs his memory, he needs intelligence. He needs his will to overcome his raw, animalistic, destructive instincts that have slumbered in the state of being in unawareness. Without will and intelligence, he could not discriminate and refrain from doing acts

that are harmful for others and for himself. In other words, his actions are governed by thought, intellect, and will.

But in the second half of this cycle, man has fully mastered this stage. He is supposed to approach the threshold towards the state of being, in awareness. He often realizes that he wants something more than a satisfying material life. It does not leave him satisfied. Religious philosophies tell him about this higher state in various terms. He not only wishes for this higher state because he is unhappy or because he heard about it, but also because a deep something within urges him towards a new way of life. Yet he erroneously tries to use the same tools he needed for material life to enter into the spiritual life. And this does not work. When he attempts to reach this higher form of being by the tools of intellect, thought process, will power, the following happens. He constructs what we call images of himself as he should be, of life according to his limited past experiences. Again and again we have discussed this entire condition: repression, self-deception, nonacceptance of what he really is as against what he wants to be. All that is the product of the use of the faculties of thought process, and exercise of will proves only that they cannot bring freedom and spiritual growth. Then, thought and will create confusion and suffering. When you consider what an image is, you will see that you have used a superimposed standard to cover up what you really feel, what you really are. You no longer accept what you are and feel, in your striving to be something more or better or to attain something more or better. Both belong in the category of becoming, but becoming in the wrong sense, in the sense of leading away from yourself, from what you are and now have. The state of being in a harmonious way can only come about by accepting the state as it happens to be now, disharmonious. In such acceptance, you can go about trying to understand yourself in all facets, and thereby you grow out of this state. But you never struggle out of it by covering up what you happen to be now. This will illustrate to you how the tools of intellect and will can be destructive if not used for their proper purpose. And this is the general way in your world.

Mind and will is a temporary tool in order to give directive to your outer actions and intent. They can and should be used for your physical life, for outer actions, for deciding to know the truth about yourself. But they cannot be used for spirituality. Spirituality is, above all things, love, with all its derivatives. You know very well you cannot love by forcing yourself. You can believe you do, when in reality you do not. But that does not mean you love. But love can come into being when you remove your errors, your confusions, your preconceived ideas, your dependencies on the opinion of others, and so on. All of these can be removed only by fully understanding them. Then love comes into being by itself, as the real self comes into being by itself.

You cannot make up your mind, go through an act of decision to be a good person, to love, to have compassion or humility. But you can make up your mind, go through an act of decision to find out what causes you not to be all of that, to find out who you are -- and thereby remove what stands in your way to be that good and loving person, and also what stands in the way between you and a full life, inner freedom, fulfillment of your potentials, in other words, to be your real self.

Can you now perhaps understand a little better why thought process, intellect, mind, and will obstruct the birth of the real self? of love? of all the qualities that are called spiritual? All of this happens as by itself as a result of knowing and understanding yourself. It is not to be expected as a direct result. Thought and will can only produce thought and will, they cannot produce something

that has nothing to do with them. Love, transcendent understanding, and all other qualities of the real self have nothing to do with thought and will.

Anyone who has gone through a creative process will readily admit that genuine creation is not determined by an act of will or by a thought he directed into the channel he may think brings forth such a creative experience. Creation comes unbidden, unexpected. When you expect it least, it is there. It is the same with the creative manifestation of the real self; with a genuine feeling of love and profound understanding, as against the superficial, intellectual feeling that merely recites and repeats -- either other people's teachings or one's own previous genuine experiences.

Superimpositions hide the real self. This is obvious. Superimpositions occur because mind and will take them on. Without the mind to decide and the will to go through with it, no superimpositions could occur. You superimpose because you strive for happiness, for recognition, even if this means spiritual development. The state of becoming is striving. If one is not in the state of becoming, there is no striving, therefore there is no danger of confusion and suffering. Take the lowest stage of development, mineral life. It has the least of awareness, will, and the very least of mind. There is no misery. In the state of being, there is no misery. Neither will misery go with growing into the state of being, in awareness, but only when man has learned to go through the state of becoming in all of its facets by first using mind, intellect, thought, and will in the organic way. When, however, inorganic, unnatural use has occurred, it is necessary to remove that surplus and those obstructions that have been caused by misuse of these faculties. One cannot say that mind, intellect, and will cause suffering and misery; but their use when they should not be used do have that effect. Your mind is responsible for all the images, wrong conclusions, petrifications, generalizations, and all that is crippling in you. So you have to use this same instrument to remove these conditions. And this can be done only by understanding fully and deeply, not just superficially.

There are many religious systems which realize the danger of the mind. They try to eliminate mind and will functioning. This cannot work. Do not accept my word for it, my dear ones. I always ask you never to do that. But think about it. When you really think about it, you will see for yourself that this is so. When you artificially cut out the mind by exercise and discipline, what happens? You repress what still exists in you, and whenever confronted with a crisis to which you cannot apply these exercises, that which was repressed and out of your awareness again appears on the surface. So it is only a question of how successfully you repress from sight and awareness that which still happens to exist. Therefore any exercise of cutting out the mind, cutting out trends, thoughts, emotions, attitudes that are not to your liking, is something artificial and never, never brings genuine liberation. Liberation does not have to fear negative circumstances. It does not have to use discipline or any exercise; for what is not there does not have to be manipulated. This is simple logic. The only way to dissolve the undesirable is to understand it, to know it, to own up to it.

Please do not think I propose to dissolve the mind altogether. Then you would become an imbecile. As long as you live in this world, you need the mind. But dissolve its negative workings, its use in areas of your being where the mind is a hindrance and a direct cause of your misery and confusion, a direct hindrance to the creative process of your real self. Many of my friends have experienced this manifestation, not only in creative art but also when a profound thought or feeling of love or a new way to approach life has sprung from a deep source within. It comes from another area, and when you observe it, you will see that it is as though you had another brain, another seat of

feeling and reacting within yourself. At the beginning, it does not happen often, but it will increase in frequency and duration as you understand yourself more thoroughly. Do not try to artificially and voluntarily reproduce it. It will not work. The moment you do that, you again use the tools of mind and will where they cannot be successful and functional.

As regards these two areas of thought -- the superficial intellect and the real self -- the former can be directed, manipulated at will and is governed by the will. The latter cannot. But it is much more intelligent, much more certain, and much more reliable. It is always constructive. You never even have to make a choice. It is there, it stands there as the one and only truth without any question or doubt. Question and doubt are part of the superficial intellect, the mind. But the latter, the real self, is a product, a result that is being born in you slowly, slowly, with interruptions, only to the degree that you understand and accept yourself as you happen to be now. As you accept the reality of your actual state now, so the reality of the real self can manifest.

One of the intrinsic qualities of the real self is that it reacts forever new to each experience and aspect of life. It is never governed by the past. Therefore its way of experiencing is as poignant as that of a child. But when your impressionable mind has made an image out of an experience, has petrified this one-time experience into a general rule and law, your present and future ability to experience is limited to the past experience. And therefore the freshness goes out of it, and often the truth, because the present has, in reality, no resemblance to the past, or it need not or would not if you would not mold it into this image. Perhaps now you will understand better what we have discussed, worked on, and looked at in all this time. The only way to dissolve these past experiences, deeply imprinted on your conscious or unconscious mind and to free yourself of its limiting and erroneous effect is to become aware of it, look at it, understand it in its full scope and depth, with all of its significance. This can be done only if you are truly willing to face yourself in absolute candor, if you are willing to dispense with any hankering as to what you should be, as opposed to what you are. Again and again, I have to repeat that this cannot be done if you moralize yourself. This constant self-moralizing, which often exists in such subtle, devious, hidden ways, prohibits the understanding of that which causes misery in your life. This misery is always self-produced. It never comes from outside, no matter how much it may so appear when looked at superficially.

It often happens that a person is basically ready to enter the second half of the cycle -- approaching the threshold toward the state of being, in awareness. Yet he opposes the organic growth into this state by artificially holding on to this overemphasis on the mind, intellect, and outer will. By curbing the will, by manipulating thought, by disciplining emotions, he believes that he can attain growth and the experience of the real self. When he temporarily seems to have a precarious, conditioned peace, he is encouraged into believing he is on the right road. But when his smoldering inner reality manifests so as to disrupt him in this false peace, he despairs with himself. If only he would let go of superimposing knowledge, of trying to live up to ideals that inwardly he is not yet able to live up to, he would not misuse the tools of the intellect and will and thereby create more obstructions. If only the concepts were of lesser importance than what he really feels, then he would not obscure a jewel, the jewel of the real self. Man holds on to these tools because he feels unsafe without them. He does not trust himself to be without the rules, laws, concepts, and ideals from outside. Without the knowledge of what is right and good, he unconsciously thinks he cannot let go of superimposed standards. He ignores the fact that if only he would do so, look at himself as he really is, then he would have nothing to fear. In order to do so, he would have to see, first that

the superimpositions exist, and then he would have to determine why they do. He will come to see that security plays a role. This kind of holding on to security cannot bring the real self into being. If you follow this procedure, you will not obstruct the growth that you are inherently ready for.

Do not try to cut out by force the overemphasis on outer intellect and will. Use it rather to see, to understand what is in you, to accept yourself without moralizing. Do not get away from it, but use it only so as to indirectly bring about the constant renewal and regeneration process, the direct experience of creative spontaneity that only the real self can give.

What you may find within yourself may very well be the same as the superimposed standards that you adopt from outside. Yet there is a world of difference between the two. Only what comes genuinely out of yourself is of value. You cannot find that which is genuinely within yourself, behind all the destructive patterns and images, if you are not ready to dispense with the superimposed, intellectualized concepts and thus look at yourself naked. No matter how true a concept that you adopt may once have been for the person who has experienced it, it is no longer a truth if it is repeated in action and thought only.

What I am saying here is old wisdom, and much of it I said before. But very little of it has been truly understood. So I try now to say it again in different words. The phase most of my friends are approaching now requires the awareness of everything that I said tonight. This dependency on outer standards, on superimposed ideals cannot be whisked away any more than any other immature state you find yourself in. But recognize it for what it means, investigate it, acknowledge the fact that you are in this dependency!

And now to your questions.

QUESTION: In my work, I found that because I have to justify myself for what I do, I condemn myself as well. I realize that this seems to be a defense mechanism. It forms my wrong conclusions and images in some way, sort of an emotional confusion I have been intellectualizing. Will you please suggest an approach to this problem of self-justification and self-condemnation. I find myself confused as to whether or not I'm justifying or condemning myself in this way.

ANSWER: As you become aware of this justifying yourself, ask yourself why you are doing so. Would anyone justify what he does not somehow feel needs justification? If you feel it needs justification, you must condemn or judge or moralize yourself. There can really be no justifying without moralizing. Then ask yourself clearly, what is it exactly that you condemn? Then ask yourself why you condemn it. It will be easy to see that you do so, not because of an innate knowledge, but mainly and above all because you have heard this. Your society and environment condemns, so you do too. Now, it may very well be that you wish to be without this trend or tendency, apart from the superimposed standards you are indoctrinated with. You may feel, for many reasons, that you will lead a fuller and more constructive life. But before you can be aware of your own innate desire, you have to separate the latter from the superimposition and dependency on public opinion. Then, in order to resolve the problem that hinders your full unfoldment, you have to understand the problem. But you cannot do so if you justify and condemn yourself for the problem. This I have said so many times, but it is always forgotten. You cannot find out the truth of yourself, of the existence of your problems, when you approach it with an attitude of right versus wrong, good versus bad.

The mere fact that you wish to be without the problem would not cause justification and condemnation. This only happens because you wish to live up to superimposed standards and ideals. And you do so because you cannot accept yourself as you happen to be now. You already want to be different. You run away from what you are, and this prohibits growing out of your problem. You can only grow out of it if you accept it as being a part of you, accept that you have that problem. If you fully accept it, you no longer justify or condemn. You have given up the ideal and therefore the outer standards.

If someone wants something and there is no living up to outside standards and preconceived ideas, he will not need justification and condemnation if he does not immediately succeed. Let us suppose someone wants to write, but cannot. The mere wish will not make him condemn himself. But if his society proclaims that everyone who does not write commits a crime, a sin, or is inferior, then in addition to the simple wish, he will begin to condemn himself -- and therefore justify himself to ward off the brunt of his self-condemnation. He will find excuses, explanations, reasons, -- all a cover for his self-condemnation.

Now, separate these two aspects. Become aware of your dependency on public opinion. Find out why you want to resolve your problem. Then be aware that whenever you look at the problem, you are condemning and justifying. The more you do so, the less will you justify and condemn. And that is the beginning of understanding the problem. As you are aware and understand your self-moralizing and self-justification, they diminish by the act of observing them. So will the problem resolve by the act of understanding it and observing yourself with all the reactions that are connected with it. But the latter cannot be done before the former is put out of the way.

So much unhappiness is caused by the compulsive need to live up to what you know exists. If you would not know it, this unhappiness would not be. Thus unhappiness is often determined by comparison. Therefore it is not genuine. To take a primitive example, let us suppose someone is of modest means. He does not starve, but he has less than his neighbors. If everyone else were to live like he does, he would not be unhappy, but because others have more, he is. Is that real unhappiness? If it is not real, it comes from the mind, from superimposed ideas, from outer knowledge -- and therefore it leads away from the real self. It might be well worth your consideration to look at your unhappiness from that point of view. Even though many an unfulfillment would still persist because it springs from a genuine need, a surplus drive will be taken off the edges by seeing that it is aggravated by comparing yourself to others and by outer knowledge. Becoming aware of the urge and compulsion will leave the genuine wish free and hence open to understand the obstructions.

The state that might genuinely make you unhappy cannot be understood and therefore dissolved as long as you are driven by superimposed standards. As long as shame and pride induce moralizing and justifying, you cannot grow out of the problem because you cannot understand it. So, look at all this in a calm way, without hurry or the haste to get over it immediately.

QUESTION: I was under the impression that the mind is the builder, but according to what you say, it seems to me the emotions are the builder. Am I correct?

ANSWER: Both are builders. Both can be builders for something constructive or destructive. If they are used for something they are not organically destined for, then it will be destructive. If the mind wants to build a spiritual state, hiding the actual emotions, it is destructive. If the mind builds on what it finds of its own distortions, it will be constructive. Emotions which are aware, even if negative, cannot build anything destructive. But unaware negative emotions are bound to build destructive results. Positive emotions build constructive results. If the mind is used for building material things, it is constructive because this is what the mind is for. You need the mind to form intent so as to remove what the mind has built up negatively. There is no strict borderline between mind and emotion. They intermingle. Both thought and emotions can be of the mind. And another region of your being -- the real self -- produces different thought and different feeling.

QUESTION: I would like to ask two questions in connection with yoga. Is what you said tonight the same as what yoga calls "to become the mirror of reality," and also that the mind should become the slayer of the mind in order to reach reality?

ANSWER: Yes, it is the same, only it is very often used in a wrong way. It is used in a way of force, of superimposing, of forcefully cutting out something. Even the word "slayer" suggests this deep and unfortunate misunderstanding. In it is implied a wrong process. If you try to slay the mind, it merely hides. It can only dissolve by a process of understanding. A confusion is not eliminated by a forceful act of tearing it out. This only makes you repress the awareness of its existence. But if you look at the confusion without compulsion, without haste, without moralizing, without denial, then you can hope for the understanding that is necessary to grow out of it. "Slaying" suggests compulsion, haste, moralizing -- so it cannot be the way. Haven't most of you on this path experienced this phenomenon already? Whenever you come across an aspect that you do not like and you encounter it with the impatience to get rid of it, it always reappears in one form or another sooner or later. But when you calmly look at it, you reach a deeper level of understanding, and thus, slowly, this aspect truly begins to lose force and impact. Whenever it still reappears and you do not become impatient with yourself but try to recognize more about yourself from its existence, you become calm and peaceful, but certainly not by "slaying" it, which is just another word for saying whisking it away. Whisking it away can only produce repression, and repression is self-deception. You think you do not have it because you are not aware of it. But that is not getting rid of anything. Hence, force leads only to self-deception and illusion. But letting the undesirable be, to float on the surface, you observe it; you learn to understand it. You get behind it and see what is there. This is the only way, my friends. Cutting out or slaying would be a short cut, and there is no short cut to growth and genuine spiritual and emotional health. When you let it be in full awareness, by that it ceases to be after full, profound understanding has come.

Those teachers who have made these statements, have perceived certain truths. But I doubt that anyone who has perceived and experienced the truth in this respect can advocate "slaying." Those who do, have adopted an experience of someone else; they repeat what they heard -- and give themselves away to those who know. It is also possible, of course, that wrong terms are used by translators and others who try to give to the world what one person experienced. Such procedures of "slaying," etc., lead further away from the real state of being. It may lead to an illusory, imaginary state of being.

The great spirits of all times have said, and will say, what I have been trying to tell you for a number of years from different approaches and points of view. They may have used different words, but the essence always remains the same. Jesus spoke of not resisting evil. This is what he meant. If you resist the evil, the confusion, the distortions, you only drive it underground. If you do not resist it, you can see it. You automatically have the humility of not trying to be more than you are, and thereby you have the basic prerequisite to grow out of it -- to be reborn into your real self. Cutting out, forcing, disciplinary action, slaying, is resisting. When you judge it, you resist. When you justify it, you resist.

QUESTION: What then is the right self-discipline?

ANSWER: I believe that this lecture, as well as all previous ones, amply go into this question. One of the points I make again and again is that disciplinary action is force and therefore leads away from self-knowledge. The intent to look at yourself as you are and not as you want be, yes, but discipline connotes compulsion, suppression, repression, forceful action -- all short cuts, all illusions, all measures to strengthen the idealized self-image.

As I have said in this lecture, intellect, will, and therefore also discipline are necessary for your outer actions, for your physical life, for preventing destructive impulses to manifest. But when it comes to the growth of your inner being, discipline is very harmful. If you discipline your thoughts and emotions, you force them into being something else than they are. If you intend again and again to look at yourself in truth, this is not discipline. It is an intention which you follow through. If you use your will for the purpose of "I want to know myself," it is good, constructive, realistic. But if you use your will to be something you are not yet, how can that be real? If you look at yourself calmly without moralizing, without justifying, without complaining or resenting, then you do not discipline yourself. If you find such tendencies and look at them, you do not discipline yourself. You simply look at what is there. Do you understand?

QUESTION: I don't know how a person can live without self-discipline.

ANSWER: That is something completely different. But I made this so clear in this lecture, as well as in the previous ones, for that matter, that I believe if you calmly reread it, and open your mind, you will see what I mean. Of course, the immature soul has many destructive impulses which can only be prevented from action by discipline. But I do not speak about that. I speak about the inner life, about the growing out of these very destructive impulses. I talk about the birth of the real self, love. Can love come into being by discipline, by an act of will? Can any creative process come into being by discipline? Can you be a good person by discipline? Certainly not. Do you understand a little what I mean?

QUESTION: There are many different ways of discipline, this is not what I had in mind. I meant channeling.

ANSWER: What do you mean by channeling?

QUESTION: The channeling of emotions.

ANSWER: When you channel your emotions, you force them to run according to what you decide with your mind how they should run. Is that genuine? Can that lead to reality? When you are off guard and do not tell them how to run, do not channel them, they will run as they are -- and you will be disappointed because you thought your channeling, disciplinary action has made them into what you want them to be, has made you into what you want to be. But you are not. If you were truly that, you would not have to channel anything. Your emotions would automatically flow in a constructive way. The moment you have to channel them, you distrust them. And rightly so, for they are still immature. How can they mature by channeling? Do you channel any living organism, a growing body? If you would, you would cripple it. And this is what happens to emotions if they are channeled. They may outwardly "behave," but that does not mean they have grown out of the immature state. But I discussed this at such length in the past that I really do not have to repeat it here. I only want to add this, channeled emotions are negative emotions manipulated. Only by letting them free will you be able to transform them through understanding them. Innately, feelings are constructive, but how can you come to them as long as you do not understand their negative distortions? By channeling your emotions, and thus yourself, how can you be free? Selfhood is freedom. Discipline and channeling lead away from freedom.

QUESTION: If one is in this state of being which is the real self and is functioning on a positive level, and then one discovers a neurotic trend on a deep level in the past, then the real self seems to disappear. Why can it not open the channels that are there, and why can you not then pursue any creative work? It disappears with the real self.

ANSWER: Yes, of course. Creativity is from the real self. To wholly be your real self means a great deal of understanding, of observation. Yet this understanding and observation are constantly interrupted by your ingrained habit of hiding and moralizing and justifying and all that goes with it. You may succeed once, and then you forget again, and the next time you come across a disturbed area, you again repress, judge, strain away from that which is. This is the difficulty one has to be aware of in order to take on the habit of looking, seeing, trying to understand completely free of all preconceived ideas. Perhaps also, the past experience of the real self causes one to take it for granted and to strive for attaining it again. Yet, striving is the very opposite of what brings out the real self. Past experience cannot be duplicated in a direct experience. But your manner of going about it -- namely, freedom from repression, from straining away, willingness to calmly and unjudgingly see what is, to understand without being in a hurry about it -- that can renew the experience.

Moreover, your real self is covered all around by the false layers of superimposition. You may have begun to remove one area and thus have reached a certain plateau, but other areas that now come to the fore are still covered. Here, the breakthrough has to be accomplished all over again by the same process. If you have that experience but a few times, it will give you great strength. Do not expect to have it at all times yet. Such expectations will have a very negative effect.

QUESTION: But you are engaged in creative work, and then, suddenly, you cannot do it anymore?

ANSWER: Because there are still certain obstructions in you which you have not fully understood. When you attained this experience, you had not yet expected it, as it came unbidden; but inadvertently, as it were, you had the right attitude I discuss so often. Then this attitude is lost

again. Instead, there is expectation of the beautiful feeling and therefore striving of the mind, striving away from what is.

QUESTION: You were talking about superimposed standards. How should we educate our children. At this stage, every standard we give to our children is superimposed.

ANSWER: Well, my dearest ones, this is a chapter that goes too far for an answer now. All I can say is that human education, at this point, is so wrong. It could be so much more constructive if the child could be educated according to teachings such as this. If self-knowledge and self-understanding, the honest facing of what is, would be cultivated in the child, there would be no conflict between two unsatisfactory alternatives of either letting all destructive impulses loose or of incarcerating the living spirit of truth for the sake of right behavior. The child could be encouraged from the beginning to develop inwardly by facing the truth, and not just develop outwardly. Thus superimposed standards would only be a structure for those who are as yet incapable of directing their behavior into constructive actions. Because education is so far behind what it really could already be at this time, moral laws become a whip, a prison, a rigid letter, and the living spirit of love cannot grow. I think it will take some time before humanity will change the educational system although some tentative beginnings are already made -- and this will increase slowly. Perhaps first in the individual homes, by individual teachers, but gradually it will become general. But until such time, many more people will have to find themselves in truth and reality as they now are, not striving to be already different. Many more people will, within themselves, have to live up to what they are instead of pretending to be something different. And that is the only way confusion, pain, and suffering can be removed. That is the only way God can come into being. Light, love, joy -- all these are the outcome of truth, not truth far beyond your state, but truth as it happens to be now within yourself.

Blessings for all of you. May these words sink in, and even if the effect is but small, they will prove tremendously helpful. Think and feel these words. Pursue these thoughts on your own so that you can accept them as truth. Separate yourself from ideas that you wish to hold on to merely because you have done so for a long time and because you still struggle to recognize yourself as you are now. All this brings nothing but strife. Be blessed, my friends, all of you. Be in peace. Be in God!

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